



Calmer Evenings

PREPARE TONIGHT TO REDUCE TOMORROW'S FRICTION

Evening routines do not need to be perfect. Choose one or two changes that fit your child and your household, then keep them predictable long enough to see what helps.

1

Give tomorrow a home base

Choose one consistent place for school bags, shoes and everyday essentials. Preparing these items in the evening can reduce the number of decisions waiting in the morning.

2

Offer one manageable choice

If clothing decisions create delays, invite your child to choose between two suitable options the evening before. The boundary stays clear while the child has a meaningful role.

3

Shift towards quieter activities

When practical, move screens out of the final hour before sleep - especially out of bed - and transition towards reading, quiet play, conversation or another calming activity.

4

Keep the sequence predictable

Use a short order that fits your family, such as bathroom, teeth, pajamas, preparation for tomorrow, story and bed. Consistency matters more than creating a perfect routine.

START SMALL

Use only one new change for seven evenings before adding another. Look for less confusion and fewer repeated reminders - not perfect compliance.



Easier Mornings

FEWER DECISIONS. CLEARER NEXT STEPS.

A calm start is not built from stricter commands. It is built by reducing unnecessary decisions, showing the next step and giving the child repeated opportunities to practise the sequence.

1 Give the morning a little margin

If circumstances allow, even a few extra minutes can reduce pressure for both parent and child. A routine that requires perfect speed every day is difficult to sustain.

2 Choose an order that fits your family

Dressing may happen before or after breakfast. What matters most is using a clear, repeatable sequence with only the essential steps.

3 Point first, then prompt

Refer to the visible routine and use one short instruction at a time. Try: 'What comes next?' Then allow enough time for the child to respond before adding another reminder.

4 Make departure easy to see

Keep bags, shoes and essential items in one predictable place. The goal is not to do every task for the child, but to make the route to leaving easier to understand and complete.

NOTICE ONE USEFUL OUTCOME

For one week, count how many repeated adult reminders are needed. If the number falls, the routine may be carrying more of the work while the child learns the sequence.



Evening Routine Checklist

A VISIBLE PATH FROM BUSY TIME TO BEDTIME

Name: _____

Week of: _____

Ages 3-6

☐ 1 Put toys in their home

☐ 2 Put on pajamas

☐ 3 Brush teeth

☐ 4 Choose a story or quiet activity

☐ 5 Goodnight routine and lights out

Ages 7-12

☐ 1 Pack school bag and homework

☐ 2 Choose tomorrow's clothes

☐ 3 Brush teeth and wash face

☐ 4 Put devices in their charging place

☐ 5 Read or unwind quietly, then lights out

Use it as support, not as a test

- Place the checklist where your child can see and reach it.
 - Point to one next step instead of repeating the full routine.
 - Help with the blocked step, then return control to the child.
- Change the order or wording when needed. Consistency matters more than perfection.



Morning Routine Checklist

FEWER DECISIONS. CLEARER NEXT STEPS.

Name: _____

Week of: _____

Ages 3-6

☐ **1 Wake up and use the bathroom**

☐ **2 Get dressed**

☐ **3 Eat breakfast**

☐ **4 Brush teeth**

☐ **5 Shoes, bag and ready to go**

Ages 7-12

☐ **1 Wake up and get dressed**

☐ **2 Eat breakfast**

☐ **3 Brush teeth and hair**

☐ **4 Check bag and essentials**

☐ **5 Shoes on and ready at the door**

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- Help with the blocked step, then return control to the child.

Change the order or wording when needed. Consistency matters more than perfection.